

The jQuery framework operates on the principle of chaining, or connecting expressions end to end. It usually uses a dollar sign (\$) to begin an expression. jQuery developers will often replace the \$ notation with the word “jQuery” because Prototype developers are used to the identical notation. In WordPress, for compatibility reasons, jQuery is used in this “no conflict” mode, which uses jQuery instead.

Technically, the jQuery() function in jQuery literally means “an element designated by a CSS string.” While jQuery often uses complex selectors, it always references a CSS selector. This differs from Prototype, which uses Document Object Model (DOM) IDs, discussed later in this chapter, where \$ indicates “element with ID of.” The nuance between these two paradigms is slight, but is extremely important to understand in development. To use jQuery in a theme, you must have a ready event. The ready event is a statement that ensures that the entire page, or DOM as it’s known in JavaScript development, has been loaded. It is expressed as jQuery(document).ready() and wraps around all jQuery expressions.

Wrapping all expressions in a ready event

```
<script type="text/javascript">
jQuery(document).ready(function() {
// Insert all jQuery expressions here
});
</script>
```

In a practical sense, you can use jQuery for almost anything. For example, assume that you implement a search form in a hidden layer. The way this form is exposed is by clicking on a link.

Basic HTML structure for a div that contains a search form and a link

```
<a id="search_link" href="#">Search</a>
<div id="example_search_form">
<?php get_search_form() ?>
</div>
```

Using a function to add CSS to the theme

```
function additional_css()
{
?>
<style type="text/css">
#example_search_form { display:none; }
</style>
```